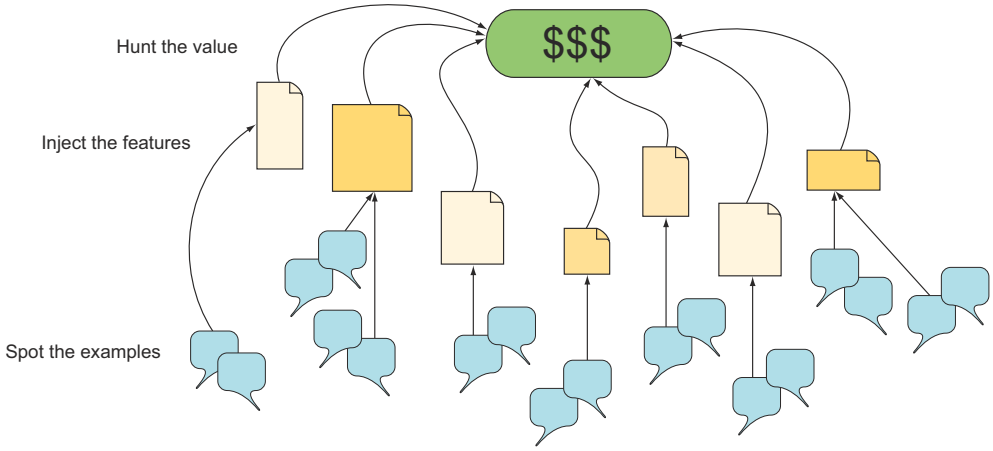


Figure 3.2 Feature Injection involves a three-step process: hunt the value, inject the features, and then spot the examples.

with stakeholders in order to progressively explore, elaborate, and expand on a shared understanding of what needs to be delivered and why. It revolves around a simple three-step process (see figure 3.2):[3]

1. Hunt the value.
2. Inject the features.
3. Spot the examples.

3.2.1 Hunt the value

Many Agile teams build up a large list of user stories (often referred to as a *backlog*), and then prioritize the stories to decide which features they really need to build in the next iteration. But sifting through stories to find the high-value ones takes time and effort, especially as the list of stories grows longer. Wouldn't it be easier if the stories you don't really need weren't placed in the list in the first place?

Feature Injection does things the other way round. In Feature Injection, you start by trying to clarify exactly how you expect the system to deliver business value, and only then do you identify the features that might best deliver this outcome. This makes it easier to focus your work on the features that will deliver the best return on investment. This is what's called "hunting the value." The aim is to understand the business value that lies behind a feature so that you can objectively decide which features are really worth creating.

Teams that use Feature Injection use a number of techniques that help model the relative value of features in terms of the business value they can provide. Don't be

[3] Kent McDonald and Chris Matts, "Feature Injection: A Gentle Introduction," Agile 2009 Conference, http://agile2009.agilealliance.org/node/185/.